MASKINHALLEN · USER MANUAL · VERSION 2.0

SPÅN

MICRO-SAMPLING MINIMAL MACHINE · CHOP · SORT · DRIFT

SPÅN chops any sound into hundreds of tiny shavings and builds 90s/00s minimal techno out of them. The loop never closes.



VST3 · AU · LV2 · STANDALONE
MACOS · WINDOWS · LINUX

MASKINHALLEN

CONTENTS

01 Welcome

02 Install

03 Unlock with your key

04 Your first minute

05 The Radio Seeker and the boxes

06 The eight lanes

07 The roll

08 Groove DNA

09 The half-step bass

10 BÅGEN

11 GULD

12 Colour, the floor guarantee and SLINGAN

13 SPÅN 2: more sounds, more machines

14 Presets and troubleshooting

15 Troubleshooting

01 WELCOME

SPÅN (Swedish for shavings, the curls of metal that come off a lathe) is an instrument for minimal techno that never closes the loop.

Most producers do not get stuck on sounds. They get stuck in the eight-bar loop: tweaking the same pattern until the spark is gone. In minimal techno the drama is tiny: a percussion hit moving one sixteenth, a sound swapped for its sibling, a bass sliding half a step before the phrase turns. SPÅN does those small moves for you, all the time, while you pick what you like.

- **The Radio Seeker** chops any audio into shavings of 5 to 400 ms and sorts them into five boxes by timbre: KLICK, TICK, RÖST, TON and BRUS.
- **Eight lanes**: a fixed anchor kick, a mono bass, and six lanes that play shavings.
- **The roll** never loops: every lane mutates a little at a time, remembers its old variants and sometimes returns to them.
- **Groove DNA**: swing and accent profiles: straight and shuffled 909, a loose sampler slap, a drunk lag, microhouse, Romanian minimal and Detroit. Or extract your own from a loop.
- **BÅGEN** rides a long energy curve over 6 to 45 minutes and prefers taking things away to piling on.
- **GULD** records the last minutes all the time. Drag the magic moment straight into your DAW, as audio or MIDI.
- A rhythm library of minimal archetypes plus musical rules, so random never sounds broken.

ABOUT THE SWEDISH LABELS

ON SCREEN	ENGLISH	ON SCREEN	ENGLISH
`Nästa`	Next (new variant)	`Frys`	Freeze
`Tillbaka`	Back	`Nivå`	Level
`Drift`	Drift (how much it changes)	`Täthet`	Density
`Färg`	Colour (dark / bright)	`Tyst`	Mute
`Lådor`	Boxes	`Spöke`	Ghost
`Röst / Ton / Brus / Luft`	Voice / Tone / Noise / Air	`Sväng`	Swing
`Båge`	Arc (long-form arrangement)	`Ettan`	The one (downbeat reset)
`Glid`	Glide	`Ålder`	Age (sampler colour)
`Skiva / Band`	Vinyl / Tape	`Verkstad`	Workshop (details)
`Steg / Längd / Baklänges`	Steps / Length / Reverse	`Spridning`	Spread (stereo)
`Guld / Återkalla`	Gold / Recall	`Dra ut`	Drag out

THE WINDOW



02 INSTALL

Unzip the file for your system. You get a folder called **SPAN**. Then run the installer for your system and restart your DAW (or rescan plug-ins). SPÅN shows up as an instrument.

MACOS

1. Double-click `SPAN-macOS.zip` in Downloads.
2. Open Terminal and run:
   `bash ~/Downloads/SPAN/installera.command`
3. Quit your DAW completely and start it again.

VST3, AU and a standalone app. macOS 11 or newer, Intel or Apple Silicon. The installer copies the plug-ins and removes macOS's block on downloaded plug-ins.

WINDOWS

1. Right-click `SPAN-Windows.zip` and choose **Extract all**.
2. Open the `SPAN` folder and right-click `installera.bat` → **Run as administrator**.
3. If Windows says "Windows protected your PC": **More info** → **Run anyway**.

VST3 (in C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3) and a standalone .exe. 64-bit Windows 10 or 11.

LINUX

1. Unzip `SPAN-Linux.zip`.
2. Run `bash ~/Downloads/SPAN/installera-linux.sh`. It copies the plug-ins to `~/.vst3` and `~/.lv2`.
3. Rescan plug-ins in your DAW (Bitwig, Reaper, Ardour and others).

VST3 and LV2, 64-bit x86 Linux (built on Ubuntu 22.04).

> SWEDISH OR ENGLISH
>
> The machines have Swedish names on the panel. One click on `SV | EN` in the header switches labels, menus and tooltips to English. Your choice is remembered for every MASKINHALLEN machine.

03 UNLOCK WITH YOUR KEY

Your purchase comes with a licence key: four groups of four characters, like `XXXX-XXXX-XXXX-XXXX`. You find it in the Payhip email and on your receipt.

1. Open SPÅN. Until it is unlocked, the window shows **UNLOCK SPÅN**.
2. Paste the whole key in the field and press `UNLOCK`.
3. Done. You only need to do this once per computer: every MASKINHALLEN machine on the computer finds the key. A bundle key unlocks every machine.

The key is not case sensitive, and I/L and O/0 are treated as the same character, so a typo there does not matter. If it says the key does not work, check that the whole key was pasted. You can use your key on your own computers.

THE FREE DEMO

Every machine has a free demo with the same sound engine. Some presets and functions are locked, and the demo has its own name (SPÅN DEMO), so it can sit next to the full version. Buying the full version is what unlocks everything; install it and paste your key.

UPDATES

Updates are free for life. Download the new zip from your Payhip receipt link and run the installer again. Your projects and your key are kept.

---

04 YOUR FIRST MINUTE

1. Put SPÅN on an instrument track and press play in your DAW. It starts and stops with the transport and follows its tempo.
2. It plays straight away from its built-in raw material: synthesised voices, clicks, metallic ticks, tones and noise.
3. Press **NÄSTA**. Everything gets a new variant with the same feel. Press it until something grabs you.
4. Press **FRYS** on the lanes you love. They stay exactly as they are. Press NÄSTA again: the rest gets new variants that inherit the feel of what you froze (ARV).
5. Drag a folder of your own sounds anywhere into the window. Your shavings replace the factory ones box by box.
6. When something sounds magic, press **GULD** and drag **DRA UT WAV** into your arrangement.

---

05 THE RADIO SEEKER AND THE BOXES

Drop files, a folder or a whole library at once (wav, aiff, flac, mp3, ogg). Folders are read recursively, up to 4000 files. SPÅN chops up to 12 of them straight away in the background; the rest wait in the library.

Every shaving is analysed locally (no online service, no API key) for length, attack, brightness, noisiness and pitch, and sorted:

BOX	WHAT ENDS UP THERE
KLICK	Short, hard, mid-range hits: rims, wood, clicks.

BOX	WHAT ENDS UP THERE
TICK	Short and metallic or bright: hats, shakers.
RÖST	Voiced sound with formants: syllables, phonemes.
TON	Clear pitch: stabs, plucks, bells. Pitched into your key.
BRUS	Air, tails, textures, vinyl.
SPÖKE	Ghosts: cut from SPÅN's own output (or VENTIL's) every eight seconds.

Each box is sorted from dark to bright, so a shaving's neighbours are its siblings. When the roll swaps a shaving it picks a sibling, so the feel stays.

RADIO turns the dial for you: every 4, 8, 16 or 32 bars it picks a new file from your library, chops it and fades a quarter of each box over to the new material, like scanning a radio. **FABRIK** brings back the factory material, **RENSA** empties the library.

06 THE EIGHT LANES

LANE	ROLE	MUTATES?
KICK	The anchor. Synthetic 909-style kick: TON, LÄNGD, KLICK and DRIV.	Never
BAS	Mono sub with the half-step glide.	Carefully
KLICK, TICK, RÖST, TON	Shavings from their boxes.	Yes
LUFT	Air and texture.	Slowly
SPÖKE	Your own output, often backwards and low.	Yes

Each strip has four knobs: **NIVÅ** (level), **DRIFT**, **TÄTHET** (density) and **FÄRG** (dark to bright). Click the lane name to open its **VERKSTAD** (workshop): STEG (0 = AUTO from the rhythm library, 3–32 for your own polymeter), TON (transpose), LÄNGD (gate), BAKLÄNGES (reverse chance), SPRIDNING (stereo spread), ÅLDER (sampler colour per lane), LÅDA (which box the lane plays) and TYST (mute).

The strip shows the roll moving past a fixed playhead: you can literally see that it never repeats the same way.

07 THE ROLL

There is no pattern length and no loop end. Each lane is a roll that plays forward in time.

- **DRIFT**: how much the lane may change. 0 = stands still. Around 35 % = roughly one small change per eight bars. 100 % = something every bar.
- The changes are small and musical: move a hit one sixteenth, swap a shaving for a sibling, toggle a ghost note, add or remove a single hit, open or close the filter a little, change a pitch, or return to an old variant.
- Every change is checked against **rules for the role** (no machine-gun clicks, the bass avoids the kick, hats keep their offbeats...). If a change would sound broken, it is thrown away.
- **Memory**: each lane remembers its last 16 variants and sometimes goes back. That is what makes it feel composed rather than random.
- **Deterministic**: all randomness is seeded by the bar number. Play from the same position and it sounds the same, so you can still arrange on top in your DAW.
- **ETTAN**: skewed polymeter lanes (7, 9, 11...) reset every 4, 8 or 16 bars, so everything lands on the one.

NÄSTA · FRYS · TILLBAKA · ARV

- **NÄSTA** (big button): a new variant of everything with the same key, groove DNA and colour. Each lane also has its own NÄSTA.
- **FRYS**: locks a lane exactly as it is; DRIFT stops until you release it.
- **ARV** (inheritance): with any lane frozen, NÄSTA makes new variants that grow out of the current ones instead of starting over. Freeze a lane and press its own NÄSTA for the same effect on just that lane.
- **TILLBAKA**: steps back through the last 16 variants. Nothing is lost.

08 GROOVE DNA

Each profile is micro-timing per sixteenth, accents and ghost-note probability.

`909 RAK`	Machine straight.	`909 SHUFFLE`	Classic 909 shuffle.
`SLAPP SAMPLER`	Loose sampler feel.	`BERUSAD GUNG`	Drunk, hits hanging behind.
`MIKROHUS`	Tight with drag on the hats.	`ROMINIMAL`	Long, hypnotic, leaning forward.
`DETROIT`	Heavy on 2 and 4.	`EGEN`	Your own, extracted from a loop.

SVÄNG blends from straight (0) to full DNA (100 %) and a bit beyond (120 %). For **EGEN**, press EGEN... or drop a drum loop on the groove selector. SPÅN assumes the loop is whole bars in your current tempo.

09 THE HALF-STEP BASS

The bass plays short rolling figures in the key and scale you choose (TONART, SKALA). **GLID** is the chance that, in the last bar of a phrase of 8, 16 or 32 bars, the bass slides half a step up or down and returns on the one. It is the tiny drama that replaces the drop. Hold a MIDI note to change key live.

10 BÅGEN

This solves “I have a loop but no track”. **BÅGE** at 0 is a static jam. Turned up, SPÅN rides a long curve over **6, 10, 20 or 45 minutes** (45 = all-night mode): intro, build, peak, breakdown, return, outro.

- The curve controls how many lanes play, how open the filters are and how much drift is allowed.
- **LUCKA** (gaps): minimal is about taking away, so the arc silences a lane for 4–16 bars rather than adding layers.
- It follows your DAW's position: the same place in the song always sounds the same.

11 GULD

SPÅN records its own output all the time (5, 10 or 20 minutes; the length is set in the parameter list and takes effect when the plugin restarts).

- The last 32 bars are selected automatically. Drag across the waveform to choose another region; double-click to go back to automatic.
- **GULD** sets a bookmark now. It also saves the state of the roll.
- **ÅTERKALLA** recalls the bookmark in the selection, so you can keep playing from exactly that moment.
- **DRA UT WAV / DRA UT MIDI**: drag the button into your DAW. Click instead to save into Music/Phunkshunz/SPÅN GULD. MIDI has one track per lane, so you can rebuild the moment with other instruments such as BETONG or KOLV.

12 COLOUR, THE FLOOR GUARANTEE AND SLINGAN

- **ÅLDER**: NY (clean), MJUK 12 (12-bit, soft aliasing), GRUS 12 (12-bit at 26 kHz, gritty), VARM (warm, slightly compressed). Global, or per lane in the workshop.
- **SKIVA**: vinyl crackle and gentle wow. **BAND**: tape saturation on the sum.

- **Floor guarantee** (always on): kick and bass stay in phase and the bass ducks for the kick; everything below 120 Hz is mono; a soft limiter keeps peaks below −0.3 dBFS; and **the Listener** lowers the least important hit when more than two lanes crowd the same frequency band.
- **SLINGAN**: put VENTIL (the sibling effect) after SPÅN and its output can come back as ghosts. Choose EGET (own output), VENTIL or BÅDA (both) and a channel 1–4 matching VENTIL. If it cannot connect, press HÄMTA VENTIL after saving in VENTIL.

13 SPÅN 2: MORE SOUNDS, MORE MACHINES

The new controls sit at the bottom of the LÅDOR panel. Everything is off by default, so old songs sound exactly as before.

- **KÄLLA** (source) decides how new sound is chopped: from files, the ghost and the sidechain. AUTO is the classic SPÅN cut. TRUMMOR makes short, tight hits. SYNT and RÖST keep whole notes and syllables and sort them into TON and RÖST. PAD makes long, soft grains that melt together. LOOP cuts in eighth notes at your song tempo.
- **SIDOKEDJA** (sidechain): send any track in your DAW to SPÅN's sidechain input. Pick SIDOKEDJA as the ghost source and the ghost lane plays chips of that track. "IN ✓" shows when sound arrives.
- **ÄTA** (eat) spreads the ghost's food into all five drawers, a little every 8 seconds. With SIDOKEDJA any track feeds SPÅN. With EGET, SPÅN slowly eats itself and turns into something new.
- **SVAR** (answer): the chip lanes step aside whenever the sidechain plays, so they answer in the gaps. Kick and bass are never touched.
- **SPELA MIDI** (play MIDI): C1 to G1 hit the eight lanes (KICK, BAS, KLICK, TICK, RÖST, TON, LUFT, SPÖKE) with the sound each one plays right now. C3 and up plays the TON chips in pitch. Works with the transport stopped too.

14 PRESETS AND TROUBLESHOOTING

64 presets in eight groups: SNETT, LEKSTUGA, PACKAT, LINDANS, MINSTA, ROMINIMAL, DUB and MASKINHALLEN. A preset sets the parameters and generates fresh patterns in its spirit. It never touches your own sound library. The last two in every group run BÅGEN; the very last uses the 45-minute arc.

TROUBLESHOOTING

- **No sound:** press play in your DAW. SPÅN follows the transport.
- **macOS says the plugin is damaged:** run the installer again; it removes the quarantine flag.
- **My files sound different every time I open the project:** SPÅN re-chops the first 12 library files in the same order when it loads, so shavings come back the same as long as the files are still there.
- **Too busy:** lower TÄTHET on TICK and KLICK, or raise BÅGE so lanes get to rest.

15 TROUBLESHOOTING

SPÅN does not show up	Quit the DAW completely and start it again, or rescan plug-ins. On Mac, run the installer again: it removes macOS's quarantine on the plug-in. On Windows, check that `SPAN.vst3` is in C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3.
macOS says the plug-in is damaged	That is macOS's block on downloaded files. Run `bash ~/Downloads/SPAN/installera.command` again.
Windows protected your PC	Click **More info** → **Run anyway**. The plug-ins are not signed with a paid certificate.
The key does not work	Paste the whole key, including the dashes. A key for one machine only unlocks that machine; a bundle key unlocks all.
No sound	Press play in the DAW: the machines follow the transport. Instruments go on an instrument track, effects on an audio track or bus.

Anything else? Ask through the store, and the person who built the machine answers.

MASKINHALLEN